IS101 — Introduction to Computing

Academic Research Paper

CSN SOC 101 · Unit 2 — Word Processing · Variation 1 · 100 points · 31 tasks

How to use this document: Download the starter file from the Project Grader, open it in Microsoft Word 365, and keep this sheet open beside it. Work through each task in order. Each task tells you what to do, why it matters, and where to find the tool — but you figure out the exact steps yourself. That's the learning. When you're done, save the file and upload it to the grader for instant scoring.

D1 — Manage Documents 19 points · 7 tasks

Task 1 3 points

Set 1-inch margins on all sides (APA standard)

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA papers require 1-inch margins on all four sides.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Layout tab → Page Setup group → Margins → Normal (1" all sides).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The Margins dialog shows 1" on Top, Bottom, Left, and Right.

Task 2 2 points

Set orientation to Portrait

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA papers are always in portrait orientation.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Layout tab → Orientation → Portrait.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The page is taller than it is wide.

Task 3 2 points

Apply the “Basic (Simple)” style set

WHY THIS MATTERS

A clean, minimal style set suits an academic paper.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Document Formatting group → Basic (Simple).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Heading styles change to a clean, understated look.

Task 4 4 points

Insert a running head with the paper title on the left and page number on the right

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA format requires a running head — a shortened title in the header area with a right-aligned page number. In this paper, use the full title “Social Media’s Impact on Las Vegas Tourism.”

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Header → Edit Header. Type the title on the left side. Press Tab twice to move to the right side → Insert → Page Number → Current Position.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
Every page shows the title on the left and a page number on the right in the header.

Task 5 2 points
Insert page numbers in the top-right of the header

WHY THIS MATTERS
APA requires page numbers in the upper-right corner of every page.

WHERE TO FIND IT
While editing the header → Insert tab → Page Number → Current Position → Plain Number.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
A page number appears in the top-right of the header on every page.

Task 6 3 points
Set document properties: Title, Author, Subject

WHY THIS MATTERS
Metadata makes the paper searchable and identifiable.

WHERE TO FIND IT
File tab → Info → Properties panel. Fill in Title, Author, and Subject.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
File {ARR} Info shows all three properties populated.

Task 7 3 points
Find & Replace: “SM” → “social media”

WHY THIS MATTERS
The starter uses the abbreviation “SM” in several places. An academic paper should spell out the full term. Note: only whole-word occurrences of “SM” should be replaced — not letters inside other words.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Home tab → Editing group → Replace (Ctrl+H). Find: SM, Replace with: social media. Click “More” and check “Find whole words only,” then Replace All.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
No remaining “SM” abbreviations in the document.

D2 — Format Text & Paragraphs 22 points · 7 tasks

Task 8 2 points
Apply the Title style to the paper’s main title

WHY THIS MATTERS
The Title style formats the first line as the document’s main heading. Apply it to “Social Media’s Impact on Las Vegas Tourism” at the top of the document.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Click on the title line → Home tab → Styles group → Title.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
The title changes to a large, distinctive font.

Task 9 4 points
Apply Heading 1 to all six major sections

WHY THIS MATTERS

Heading 1 marks the top-level sections for the Table of Contents. The six sections are: Introduction, Literature Review, Methodology, Results, Conclusion, and References.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click each section name → Home tab → Styles group → Heading 1. Repeat for all six.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

All six section names share the Heading 1 look and appear in the Navigation Pane.

Task 10 4 points

Apply Heading 2 to all six subsections

WHY THIS MATTERS

Heading 2 marks the second level of structure. The six subsections are: Prior Research, Research Design, Survey Findings, Research Questions, Key Findings, and Second Set of Research Questions.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click each subsection name → Home tab → Styles group → Heading 2. Repeat for all six.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

All six subsection names use Heading 2 and appear indented in the Navigation Pane.

Task 11 3 points

Set line spacing to double (2.0) on all body text

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA format requires double spacing throughout the paper.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select all text (Ctrl+A) → Home tab → Paragraph group → Line Spacing → 2.0.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

All text is double-spaced; the Paragraph dialog shows Line spacing: Double.

Task 12 3 points

Set a 0.5-inch first-line indent on body paragraphs

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA format requires the first line of every body paragraph to be indented 0.5 inches. Apply this to the paragraphs under each section — not to headings, the title, list items, or the table. For example, the paragraphs under Introduction, under Prior Research, under Research Design, under Survey Findings, and under Conclusion should all be indented.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the body paragraphs (click in one, then hold Ctrl and click in others, or select a range) → Home tab → Paragraph dialog launcher (small arrow) → Indentation → Special: First line → By: 0.5" → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The first line of each body paragraph is indented; headings and lists remain flush left.

Task 13 4 points

Apply the Intense Quote style to the thesis statement

WHY THIS MATTERS

Character styles emphasize key text without changing the paragraph structure. Apply the Intense Quote style to the thesis statement in the Introduction: “This paper examines the relationship between social media engagement and tourism trends.”

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the thesis statement sentence → Home tab → Styles group → Intense Quote.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The sentence appears in a distinctive italic/indented format different from surrounding text.

Task 14 2 points

Insert a page break before the References section

WHY THIS MATTERS

References should start on their own page in APA format.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click just before the word “References” → press Ctrl+Enter.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The References section starts at the top of a new page.

D3 — Tables & Lists 16 points · 6 tasks

Task 15 4 points

Convert the survey data to a 4-column table

WHY THIS MATTERS

The survey data under “Survey Findings” is currently plain text separated by vertical bars (|). Convert it to a proper table. Select all four lines from “Platform” through the last row.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the survey data text (from “Platform | Users Surveyed...” through the last row) → Insert tab → Table → Convert Text to Table → Separate text at: Other, type | (pipe character) → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The survey data appears in a clean 4-column table.

Task 16 3 points

Merge the header row cells of the survey table

WHY THIS MATTERS

Merging creates a spanning title across the top of the table.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the top row of the survey table → Table Layout tab → Merge Cells.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The top row is one wide cell spanning all columns.

Task 17 3 points

Sort the survey table by percentage (descending)

WHY THIS MATTERS

Sorting organizes the data from highest to lowest response rate.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the Percentage column → Table Layout tab → Sort → Sort by: Column 4 → Descending → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Instagram (90%) appears at the top, Twitter/X (50%) at the bottom.

Task 18 2 points

Create a numbered list of the first set of research questions

WHY THIS MATTERS

Numbered lists show sequential or ranked items. The three research questions under “Research Questions” should be numbered.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the three research questions under the “Research Questions” heading → Home tab → Numbering.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
Each research question is numbered 1, 2, 3.

Task 19 2 points
Create a bulleted list of key findings

WHY THIS MATTERS
Bulleted lists present non-sequential items. The three items under “Key Findings” should be bulleted.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Select the three findings under “Key Findings” → Home tab → Bullets.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
Each finding has a bullet (•).

Task 20 2 points
Restart list numbering for the second set of research questions

WHY THIS MATTERS
The “Second Set of Research Questions” should start numbering at 1 again, not continue from the first set.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Right-click the first question under “Second Set of Research Questions” → Restart at 1.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
The second set starts at 1 instead of continuing from 4.

D4 — References 12 points · 3 tasks

Task 21 4 points
Insert a Table of Contents

WHY THIS MATTERS
An automatic TOC lists all sections and subsections with page numbers.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Click at the top of the document (before the title) → References tab → Table of Contents → Automatic Table 1.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
A TOC appears listing all Heading 1 and Heading 2 entries with page numbers.

Task 22 4 points
Customize the TOC to show Heading 1 and Heading 2 only

WHY THIS MATTERS
Limiting the TOC to two levels keeps it concise for a research paper.

WHERE TO FIND IT
References tab → Table of Contents → Custom Table of Contents → Show levels: 2 → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
The TOC shows only major sections and subsections, not deeper levels.

Task 23 4 points
Insert 2 footnotes citing sources

WHY THIS MATTERS
Footnotes provide source citations at the bottom of the page. Insert a footnote after the statistic “78% of travelers” in the Literature Review, and another after “3.2 million impressions” in the same section. Type a brief source citation in each.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click after the statistic → References tab → Footnotes group → Insert Footnote → type the citation. Repeat for the second statistic.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
Small superscript numbers appear after each statistic, and citations appear at the bottom of the page.

D5 — Graphic Elements 21 points · 4 tasks

Task 24 4 points

Insert an image or screenshot for the bar chart figure

WHY THIS MATTERS
The starter has a placeholder "[INSERT BAR CHART FIGURE HERE]" in the Results section. Replace it with any image (a chart screenshot, a placeholder image, or a picture from your files).

WHERE TO FIND IT
Delete the placeholder text → Insert tab → Pictures → choose any image file → Insert.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
An image appears in place of the placeholder text.

Task 25 2 points

Set text wrapping to Top and Bottom on the chart image

WHY THIS MATTERS
Top and Bottom wrapping places the image on its own line with text above and below.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Click the image → Picture Format tab → Wrap Text → Top and Bottom.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
Text flows above and below the image, not beside it.

Task 26 4 points

Insert a shape and add text for a callout box

WHY THIS MATTERS
A callout box highlights a key finding. Insert a rounded rectangle shape and type a key finding inside it, such as "social media drives 64% of first-time visitor decisions."

WHERE TO FIND IT
Insert tab → Shapes → Rounded Rectangle → draw the shape → right-click → Add Text → type your callout message.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
A shape with text appears in the document.

Task 27 4 points

Position the callout shape in the right margin

WHY THIS MATTERS
Positioning the shape in the margin makes it a sidebar that doesn't interrupt the body text.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Click the shape → Shape Format tab → Position → choose "Position in Right Margin" or drag it to the right side.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
The shape sits in the right margin area alongside the body text.

Task 28 7 points

Add alt text to all figures and shapes

WHY THIS MATTERS
Alt text describes visuals for screen readers. Every image and shape in the document needs a description.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Right-click each image and shape → Edit Alt Text → type a clear description. Do this for every visual element.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
Right-clicking any image or shape shows your description in the Alt Text pane.

D6 — Collaboration 10 points · 3 tasks

Task 29 2 points

Add a comment asking the professor for feedback on the thesis

WHY THIS MATTERS
Comments let you ask questions without changing the document text.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Select the thesis statement in the Introduction → Review tab → New Comment → type a question for the professor.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
A comment bubble appears connected to the thesis statement.

Task 30 4 points

Reply to the existing comment from the writing partner

WHY THIS MATTERS
The starter contains a comment from a writing partner asking “Is the thesis statement clear enough?” Reply to it.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Click the writing partner’s comment → Reply → type your response.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
Your reply appears indented under the writing partner’s comment.

Task 31 4 points

Turn on Track Changes and revise the methodology section

WHY THIS MATTERS
Track Changes records every edit so reviewers can see what changed.

WHERE TO FIND IT
Review tab → Track Changes (toggle on) → make at least one edit to a sentence in the Methodology section.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED
Your edit appears in a different color with markup showing the change.

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